



AMITABH MATTOO



“Someone once said that when you carry a big stick, you can speak softly. India carries a toothpick and shouts from the rooftop. There is a need to develop capacities to be able to strike offensively.

We need to work with our allies around the globe and try to put pressure on Pakistan.

We need imaginative responses on Pakistan which our comatose foreign policy establishment hasn't delivered.

I believe we need to start a dialogue with Pakistan. Not having one only serves some electoral interests. ”

AJIT DOVAL

“Let the people of Pakistan believe that there is no threat from the Indian Army.

The circumstances created by the Afghanistan problem are compelling Pakistan to remain quiet.



We need a long-term policy to deal with Pakistan irrespective of the government at the Centre.

If Pakistan disintegrates, we say the overflow will come to India but we are already dealing with them. We will tackle whatever comes to us.

The best way to settle the J&K problem is to have a dialogue and the people of J&K are key to the resolution. ”

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V.K. Datta: You need to discipline Pakistan and make it reasonable. You cannot deal with an obstinate enemy unless you have brought it on the same fold on your terms. Pakistan is in turmoil. Their army is seriously engaged, so let it continue. This is the only circumstance under which Pakistan would be reasonable. As far as performance is concerned, I do not think anything great has been done.

The dialogue process has been resumed without any of our concerns or any of our demands having been conceded to. Be it Lashkar-e-Toiba or Jaish-e-Mohammed, the terrorist groups which continue to target India have not been degraded in terms of capability or their leaders. No action has been taken towards this direction. There is not one man or one weapon on the border that has been intercepted by the Pakistan Rangers and others while infiltration has continued. So let us not conclude that what India has done in last 11 months is a great success story. That nothing has happened in India is another factor.

Kiran Bedi: I have not seen the political leadership of this country build a voice. One voice. This is important when you deal with a neighbour like Pakistan. What we need is a strong India. And for a strong India, we need strong people, we need to get them together. One voice would also mean co-opting the political parties in the Opposition. An evidence of this was seen during the joint statement made at Sharm el-Sheikh where the prime minister was taken to task. That is how one voice is formed. A solid governance is an answer to a developed India, a rich India, a powerful India, and a united India that is capable of taking on an obstinate Pakistan. With our diplomats spread across the globe, when the United Nations meet, a majority of the countries talk about India and the measures we are taking. Hence, I feel diplomacy is not only important in case of Indo-Pak relations but also our relations with other countries. ■